

2026

Grade 8 FINAL EXAM

# QUESTIONS BOOKLET

The **Grade 8 English Language Arts Final Exam** has 2 BOOKLETS:

The READINGS BOOKLET contains 11 reading selections.

The QUESTIONS BOOKLET contains 75 questions.

You need them both!

**You may NOT use a dictionary, thesaurus, or other reference materials.**

BE SURE

- to write in the booklet to help you choose the best responses;
- the response you choose for each question is obvious.
- use a pencil to mark the CORRECT or BEST answer for each question, as shown in the following example:

**Question**

**Answer Sheet**

1. A rose is

- a) a fruit
- b) a flower
- c) an animal
- d) an automobile



- Mark only ONE answer for each question. If you change an answer, erase your first mark completely.

**I. Read the short story “The Strange Orchid” by H.G. Wells on pages 3-5 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 1 - 15.**

1. This story takes place
  - a. in London
  - b. in The East Indies
  - c. in a jungle
  - d. near London
  
2. The ***most important*** thing in Wedderburn’s life was his
  - a. inheritance
  - b. housekeeper
  - c. greenhouses
  - d. orchids
  
3. The ***most probable*** cause of Batten’s death, as suggested in lines 30 - 33, was
  - a. jungle leeches
  - b. the strange orchid
  - c. fainting then drowning in the swamp
  - d. contracting malaria in the jungle
  
4. Mr. Wedderburn’s ***major motive*** for buying the orchid is he
  - a. suspected it would make him famous
  - b. knew Batten would want him to grow it
  - c. wanted a frightening experience in his life
  - d. didn’t want to come back from the sale empty-handed
  
5. The ***best adjectives*** to describe the housekeeper are
  - a. negative and quick-thinking
  - b. frightened and excitable
  - c. obedient and adventurous
  - d. carefree and practical
  
6. The statement which is ***ironic*** is
  - a. “Oh, don’t say that!” (line 10)
  - b. “Is that the one who died?” (line 15-16)
  - c. “I wonder why nothing exciting ever happens to me.” (line 17)
  - d. “How awful to die in a nasty swamp.” (line 34)

7. The statement that is an example of *foreshadowing* is
- “If you’re going to London, you’d better take an umbrella.” (line 21-22)
  - “I don’t like the look of it.” (line 27)
  - “Soon there will be leaves over here.” (line 40)
  - “Go get Dr. Haddon.” (line 81-82)
8. Suspense in this story is *mainly* created by the
- actions of Arthur Wedderburn
  - character of Arthur Wedderburn
  - fact that the doctor was called
  - reactions of the housekeeper
9. The word **leeches** means (line 33)
- cannibals
  - bloodsuckers
  - large jungle animals
  - poisonous snakes
10. The asterisks (\*\*\*\*\*) are used in the story to
- show a shift in time
  - increase suspense
  - divide the text into three mini-stories
  - emphasize the two climaxes
11. The *main conflict* in this story is
- man vs. himself
  - man vs. nature
  - man vs. man
  - man vs. society
12. The *climax* of the story occurs when
- “Wedderburn hurried over to the strange orchid. It now held three great blossoms.” (line 54)
  - “At 4:30, the housekeeper had tea ready. But Wedderburn did not show up.” (line 61)
  - “She hurried back to Wedderburn’s body and tugged at him. The strange orchid crashed to the floor, still hanging on to him. She dragged them both outside.” (line 75-76)
  - “The next day, all of Wedderburn’s orchids were dead.” (line 93)

13. In the *resolution*, Wedderburn mostly felt

- a. cheerful after the event in his life
- b. regretful of the loss of all his orchids
- c. indebted to his housekeeper for saving his life
- d. in shock after his close call with death

14. The change in Wedderburn's character from the beginning of the story to end, can *best* be described as

- a. lucky to carefree
- b. lonely to lively
- c. lively to shy
- d. timid to lonely

15. The *dominant mood* in this story is

- a. fear
- b. humor
- c. frustration
- d. boredom

**II. Read the poem “LOST” by Carl Sandbug on page 6 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 16 - 18.**

16. Line 5, “Calls and cries unendly like some lost child,” is an example of:

- a. alliteration
- b. simile
- c. hyperbole
- d. personification

17. The authors use of metaphor in line 3, “Where fog trails and mist creeps,” is meant to

- a. increase sympathy
- b. decrease description
- c. increase imagery
- d. decrease tone

18. What is “hunting the harbor’s breast and the harbor’s eyes”?

- a. the fog trails
- b. the troubled poet
- c. the lonely child
- d. the lost boat

**III. Read the letter “Missing Out on Joys of River Cruising” by Jan Thygesen on page 7 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 19 - 23.**

19. What is Jan Thygesen criticizing in her letter to the editor?
- a. river safety tips for the North Saskatchewan River
  - b. jet boats and their unsafe drivers
  - c. irresponsible boaters who throw garbage in the river
  - d. the tone of a recent article that relates river boating as a dangerous activity
20. The author’s **main purpose** in the letter is to
- a. persuade the reader to take up boating
  - b. describe the beauty of the river
  - c. narrate an event on the river
  - d. explain how safe the river and boats can be
21. We can infer that Thygesen is responding to a previous article in *The Edmonton Journal* on
- a. river safety
  - b. deaths on the river
  - c. jet boat technology
  - d. joys of river cruising
22. Which statement is inaccurate based on the text?
- a. The author is somewhat of an authority on jet boat safety
  - b. The author has a bias because of a marine business connection
  - c. The author disagrees with public perceptions about river boating
  - d. The author believes the river is extremely dangerous
23. In the letter, the word **versatile** (line 19) means:
- a. experienced
  - b. lightweight
  - c. capable of adapting readily
  - d. capable of floating

**IV. Read the short story “My Left Foot” by Christy Brown on pages 8-10 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 24 - 30.**

24. “Nerves as sharp as broken glass and as taut as telegraph wires” (line 3-4) is an example of
- simile
  - hyperbole
  - alliteration
  - metaphor
25. “I can’t use these things!” he grumbled, flinging his brush down. “They’re only for girls” (line 12-13) is an example of
- foreshadowing
  - irony
  - symbol
  - stereotype
26. The **main conflict** in this selection is
- man vs. environment
  - man vs. man
  - man vs. self
  - man vs. society
27. When Christy says that he discovered “a new way to communicate” (line 40 - 41), he means that he discovered the
- joy of family discussions
  - freedom from dependence
  - pleasure of conversation with friends
  - ability to express himself in another manner
28. This story **best illustrates** the idea that
- disabilities are easily overcome
  - success requires determination and support
  - people respond to each other in many ways
  - personal commitment may result in loneliness

29. The quotation that indicates the turning point for Christy is

- a. "It works!" I managed to exclaim, and I could feel my face hot with excitement (line 28)
- b. "There was no sweating or shaking this time. I did it quite smoothly" (line 39)
- c. "I had a feeling of pure joy while I painted, a feeling I had never experienced before and which seemed almost to lift me above myself" (line 61 - 62)
- d. "Thinking it would give me less time to become unhappy" (line 65)

30. The narrator spends a great amount of time painting because he

- a. enjoyed the bright colours
- b. wanted to become an artist when he grew up
- c. found a new way to communicate to people
- d. wanted to show his siblings he was better at something than they were



V. Read the poem “Time” by Lisa Sloman on page 11 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 31 - 33.

31. The speaker in this poem is *most likely* a

- a. girl in grade two
- b. teenager
- c. mother
- d. grandmother

32. The theme of the poem is best represented by the line:

- a. “Make love, not war” (line 4)
- b. “Out to change the world” (line 5)
- c. “Now they’ve grown, and we are what they were once” (line 8 - 9)
- d. “What they thought, when they were told to.” (line 20 - 21)

33. What is the **main idea** of the poem?

- a. Young people today are uninterested in political or social change.
- b. Each generation naturally rebels against the previous one.
- c. The older generation has forgotten the values they once fought for, and now silences the younger generation for expressing similar ideals.
- d. People should always listen to authority because they have more experience.

**VI. Read the article “Unicorn-like Blind Fish Discovered” on pages 12 - 13 of your Reading Booklet and answer questions 34 - 42**

34. The bold and italicized words at the beginning of the article are intended to help the reader
- locate the author
  - understand the main idea
  - locate the sources
  - understand tone
35. In context, the words “regressive evolution,” (line 11 ) *most likely* mean
- gaining physical features over time
  - losing complex features over time
  - gaining pigmentation over time
  - losing pigmentation over time
36. What is the *overall tone* of the article?
- sarcastic and dismissive
  - serious and argumentative
  - curious and slightly humorous
  - angry and critical
37. Which clues in the fish’s features contribute to its latin name ‘longicornus’
- length and colour
  - length and width
  - length of horn
  - length of fin
38. Considering the source of the article, livescience.com, the intended audience would most likely be
- fish enthusiasts curious about new discoveries
  - fishermen intending to catch and sell fish for their livelihood.
  - environmental activists interested in protecting new species.
  - academics looking for scholarly articles on new fish species.
39. The purpose of parentheses throughout the article is to provide the reader with
- imperial conversions and too much information
  - metric conversions and clarifying information
  - a visual break for the readers’ eyes
  - measurements and unnecessary details

40. The fish's "fully formed lateral line" (line 34 - 36) serves to detect changes in
- a. pressure, salinity, and temperature
  - b. depth, air quality, and surface temperature,
  - c. pressure, air quality, and temperature
  - d. light, salinity, and temperature
41. The author, Harry Baker, would *most likely* be considered an authority in
- a. environmental conservation
  - b. evolution and climate change
  - c. marine biology
  - d. sci- fi films and Pokemon
42. In the conclusion of the article, researchers intend to solve the mystery of the S. Longicornis structure by
- a. comparing fish which share similar characteristics
  - b. comparing environmental conditions of similar species
  - c. closely studying unicorn myths
  - d. studying a sample of a rhinoceros horn

**VII. Read the short story “The King” on pages 14 - 15 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 43 - 53.**

43. The King is a

- a. dog
- b. monkey
- c. snake
- d. skunk

44. Details in the story suggest that it takes place in

- a. a foreign land
- b. a large city
- c. the desert
- d. the countryside

45. The narrator of the story is

- a. Charlie
- b. Charlie’s brother
- c. Charlie’s mother
- d. Charlie’s friend

46. Charlie’s parents ordinarily

- a. pay little attention to what he does
- b. keep strict control over what he does
- c. prevent him from keeping any animals
- d. are not at home when he needs their help

47. Up until her encounter with King, Charlie’s mother could be characterized as

- a. artistic and dreamy
- b. intolerant and hysterical
- c. moody and distractible
- d. tolerant and energetic

48. Charlie’s father ***most likely*** directed him to get rid of the King because

- a. of the way Charlie’s mother had reacted to encountering it
- b. Charlie was never supposed to bring animals to the house
- c. the King is a killer and far too dangerous to keep
- d. Charlie’s mother had insisted upon it

49. In the last paragraph, Charlie and the narrator **most likely** “waited awhile” because:

- a. Charlie’s father had told them not to come back
- b. Charlie wanted to give the King a chance to escape
- c. they wanted to make it seem as though they were burying the King
- d. they enjoyed being in the woods

50. The protagonist of this passage is

- a. Charlie
- b. the narrator
- c. Charlie’s mother
- d. Charlie’s father

51. The **main** conflict in this passage is

- a. character vs. self
- b. character vs. character
- c. character vs. environment
- d. character vs. society

52. The **climax** in this story is when

- a. Charlie takes King to the woods
- b. Charlie wraps King around his middle
- c. Charlie puts King back in his cage
- d. Charlie and the narrator sit down to supper

53. The **genre** of “The King” is

- a. horror
- b. drama
- c. comedy
- d. Sci fi

**VIII. Read the poem “To Look at Any Thing” on page 16 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 54 - 56.**

54. In the poem, “To Look at Any Thing,” the poet suggests that in order to fully appreciate nature you should:

- a. become a snake
- b. spend some time in the woods
- c. transform yourself into anything you want to know
- d. experience it as if you are part of it

55. The word “issue” in the last line means

- a. edition
- b. hide
- c. come
- d. run

56. The purpose of the words, “You must be the dark snakes of stems...” (line 8-9) are

- a. to provide setting
- b. to create a mood of fear and darkness
- c. to include wildlife in this scene
- d. to create action as contrast to the peaceful scene

**IX. Read the article “Earthquakes Rock the World” on pages 17 - 18 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 57 - 63.**

57. The author’s main purpose of this article is to

- a. persuade
- b. entertain
- c. inform
- d. convince

58. The best subheading for **Section 1** would be

- a. What is an Earthquake?
- b. Where do Earthquakes Happen?
- c. What are the Results of Earthquakes?
- d. How do you Survive an Earthquake?

59. The purpose of the dashes found in **lines 3 - 5** is to

- a. list examples
- b. share the author’s opinion
- c. provide a broader view on earthquakes
- d. add extra information

60. “It’s like bending a pencil until it cracks - *snap*” (**lines 19 - 20**) is an example of

- a. metaphor
- b. onomatopoeia
- c. alliteration
- d. personification

61. “These seismic waves **rattle** the ground” (**line 22**) is an example of

- a. alliteration
- b. metaphor
- c. personification
- d. hyperbole

62. The purpose of the statement in quotations, found in *lines 43 - 46*, is to provide
- a. a persuasive argument
  - b. data from an expert
  - c. an amusing story
  - d. opinion from an expert
63. According to the image titled “There’s a Whole Lot of Shaking Going On,” the place in Canada with the highest risk of an earthquake occurring is
- a. Calgary
  - b. Yellowknife
  - c. Ottawa
  - d. Whitehorse



**X. Read the essay “The Power of Love to Transform and to Heal” on pages 19 - 20 of your Reading Booklet and answer questions 64 - 69.**

64. Which line best identifies the **main idea**?

- a. “I wondered then if he would ever get over the wounds of neglect that the orphanage had beaten into him.” (lines 24-25)
- b. “I am amazed at what transformed this abused, terrified little creature.” (line 29)
- c. “It was not therapy, counselors or medications.” (line 30)
- d. “It was love: just simple, plain, easy to give. Love is primal.” (line 31)

65. Which word would best describe the **mood** of the piece?

- a. angry
- b. loving
- c. stressed
- d. mellow

66. What would best **define** the word “*anguished*” (line 8)?

- a. calm and peaceful
- b. full of sorrow or severe emotional pain
- c. slightly annoyed or frustrated
- d. confused or uncertain

67. What would best **define** the word “*pantomimed*” (line 14)?

- a. whispered quietly
- b. pointed directly
- c. acted out
- d. stood perfectly still

68. “*His cries were anguished, animal-like*” (lines 7 - 8). What does this comparison suggest?

- a. Luke was pretending to cry to get attention.
- b. Luke’s cries were loud and uncontrollable, like a frightened animal.
- c. Luke was angry because he didn’t get his way.
- d. Luke was mimicking the sounds he heard from outside the hotel.

69. “*Wounds of neglect*” (line 24) is an example of

- a. Personification
- b. Simile
- c. Symbol
- d. Metaphor

**XI. Read the “Calvin and Hobbes” comic on page 21 of your Readings Booklet and answer questions 70-75.**

70. The statement that **best defines** a major theme in this comic is

- a. evil is no match for youth
- b. the alien world is dark and dangerous
- c. heroes come from all age groups
- d. the youthful mind has a world of its own

71. The lines that **least suit the genre** is

- a. This could be the end!
- b. It never fails. I just washed and waxed this thing.
- c. Unscathed, the fearless space explorer emerges from the smoldering wreckage!
- d. In his weakened state, Spiff is no match for the monster!

72. Calvin’s mother **best** represents

- a. adults
- b. reality
- c. children
- d. fantasy

73. Vocabulary **most likely** used by someone Calvin’s age is

- a. intrepid
- b. unscathed
- c. emerges
- d. blasters

74. Spiff is the

- a. minor character
- b. villain
- c. antagonist
- d. protagonist

75. The **greatest contrast** can be found in

- a. alien monsters vs. friendly creatures
- b. flying a spaceship vs. crashing on a planet
- c. incredible adventures vs. everyday lunch
- d. Calvin’s behaviour vs. his mom’s expectations

**End of Examination**